

Professional SEO Checklist (50 Points)

Phase 1: Development (Before Writing Code)

1. Choose one canonical domain

Decide on one preferred version:

- <https://example.com>
- OR <https://www.example.com>

Do not let both compete.

2. Use HTTPS

Install SSL before launch

Never launch a production site over HTTP

3. Plan clean URLs

Good

[/services](#)

[/contact](#)

[/about](#)

[/blog/seo-guide](#)

Avoid

[/page?id=123](#)

[/index.php?page=1](#)

4. Create a logical site structure

Example

[Home](#)

→ [About](#)

→ [Services](#)

→ [Contact](#)

→ [Blog](#)

→ [Privacy Policy](#)

5. Plan internal linking

Every important page should be reachable within a few clicks

Phase 2: HTML Structure

6. Unique page title

Every page needs its own <title>

7. Meta description

Every page needs a meaningful description

8. Only one H1 per page

Correct

H1

H2

H2

H3

Avoid multiple unrelated H1 headings

9. Proper heading hierarchy

H1

H2

H3

Do not jump directly from H1 directly to H4

10. Semantic HTML

Use

<headers>

<nav>

<main>

<section>

<article>

<footer>

Instead of only <div> elements

Phase 3: Content

11. Original content

Avoid copying text from other sites

12. Sufficient content

Aim for at least a few hundred words on important pages where appropriate

13. Keyword naturally included

Do not stuff keyword

14. Answer user questions

Write for people first

15. Avoid duplicate content

Do not publish the same text on multiple pages

Phase 4: Images

16. Optimize image size

Compress images before uploading

17. Use descriptive filenames

Good

cardiology-clinic.jpg

Bad

IMG0003456.jpg

18. Add alt text

HTML

19. Use modern formats

Prefer WebP or AVIF where practical

20. Lazy-load images

HTML

Loading="lazy"

For non-critical images

Phase 5: Technical SEO

21. Robots.txt exists

Example

User-agent: *

Allow: /

Sitemap:

<https://example.com/sitemap.xml>

22. Sitemap.xml exists

Include every important page

23. Submit sitemap to Google Search Console

24. Canonical tag on every page

HTML

<link rel="canonical" href=<https://example.com?about>>

25. No broken links

Run a link checker before launch

Phase 6: Performance

26. Fast loading

Target a largest contentful paint (LCP) under 2.5 seconds

27. Optimize CSS

Remove unused CSS where possible

28. Minify JavaScript

29. Enable browser caching

30. Compress assets (Gzip/Brotli)

Phase 7: Mobile

31. Responsive layout

Test on phone, tablet, and desktop

32. Readable font sizes

Avoid tiny text

33. Clickable buttons

Buttons should be easy to tap

34. No horizontal scrolling

35. Pass Google's Mobile-Friendly checks

Phase 8: Accessibility

36. Proper labels on forms

37. Keyboard navigation works

38. Good color contrast

39. Descriptive link text

Instead of

Click here

Use

Book an appointment

40. Meaningful page titles

Phase 9: Analytics

41. Google Search Console connected

42. Google Analytics installed (if desired)

43. Verify indexing

Use URL Inspection after launch

44. Monitor crawl errors

Check Search Console regularly

45. Track Core Web Vitals

Review metrics periodically

Phase 10: Deployment

46. Redirect **HTTP -> HTTPS**

Use permanent (301) redirects

47. Fix all 404s

Create missing pages or remove bad links

48. Test all forms

Contact forms, appointments requests, newsletters, etc

49. Verify social sharing metadata

Include Open Graph and Twitter/X Card tags so shared links look good

50. Final production audit

Before launch, manually verify:

- Homepage loads
- All navigation links work
- Images display correctly
- No JavaScript errors in the browser console
- No broken links
- Sitemap is reachable
- robots.txt is reachable
- Canonical tags are present
- HTTPS works
- Search Console is connected

Recommended Tools

Purpose	Tool
SEO Audit	Lighthouse (Chrome DevTools)
Broken Links	Broken Link Checker or Screaming Frog SEO Spider
Performance	Google PageSpeed Insights
Search Performance	Google Search Console
Analytics	Google Analytics
Rich Results	Google Rich Results Test
robots.txt Validation	Google Search Console robots tester (where available) or manual verification
Structured Data	Schema Markup Validator
Accessibility	WAVE or axe DevTools

Ongoing Maintenance Schedule

A healthy site isn't "done" after deployment. Make these checks part of your routine:

Weekly

- Review Search Console for new indexing or crawl issues
- Confirm forms and key user journeys still work

Monthly

- Check Core Web Vitals
- Fix newly discovered broken links
- Review analytics for traffic and use behavior

- Update important content if needed

Quarterly

- Audit titles and meta descriptions
- Refresh outdated content
- Review internal linking
- Test performance on mobile and desktop

Yearly

- Renew SSL certifications (if not automated)
- Verify domain and DNS settings
- Review structured data
- Re-evaluate keyword strategy and competitors